THE ART OF THE CHASE

***Konkona Sen Sharma** on channelling a complex cop in JioStar's* Search: The Naina Murder Case*, and why she follows her creative instincts on and off screen*

Q. *You are an actor, writer and director, also judicious with your roles. How do you juggle it all?*

One can always argue that even an actor is a creator. But you are given the character, story, clothes, hair, make-up and lighting. So, in a way, you are a vessel that's just amalgamating all of it. Everything for me is just done on instinct and time. It's, let's do the most interesting things coming my way. Sometimes, they aren't.

Q. You are also said to be writing-directing a show next.

Directing is fun on set. But I am not a very open and collaborative director like my friend Rohan Sippy. I don't think I am fun at all. I find it difficult to own the material if I have not written it.

Q. A crime thriller through the prism of a police procedural is one of the most popular streaming genres. The best ones manage to show what ails society. Is *Search: The Naina Murder Case* doing the same?

The biggest draw for me was that it was an adaptation of the popular Danish show *The Killing*, one of the OG [original] crime shows with a complex female detective character. The show has been adapted very well to an Indian context. The darker part of human nature really comes out in crime and it is a very acceptable way to access it.

Q. Playing a cop is a rite of passage for an actor. How was it to sink your teeth into such a role?

I didn't have any notion of, I haven't played this or I want to play it. I like the character very much. I am playing somebody my own age, and someone who is complete. We really get into her domestic life. Then at work she's dealing with a slightly upstart kind of a person. So, it's not just one thing. There's enough to do.

—with Suhani Singh



Photograph by CHANDRADEEP KUMAR